
PAULA RIQUELME

PRODUCT LEAD · PRODUCT DESIGNER · FRONTEND DEVELOPER

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PROFILE

Product Lead, product designer, and tech entrepreneur with 8+ years building and leading digital products. Industrial Engineer with a master's degree in Innovation and Technology Entrepreneurship. Bridges discovery, product strategy, UX/UI, and frontend implementation to turn real customer problems into useful, market-ready products.

CORE SKILLS

Product: Product strategy, Product discovery, Customer research, Roadmaps, UX/UI, Prototyping, Go-to-market, Agile delivery.

Design: Figma: advanced, Adobe Illustrator: advanced, Adobe Premiere Pro: advanced.

Development: TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Next.js, Vite, AI-assisted development with Claude Code, Codex, and Kimi, Working knowledge of MongoDB, NestJS, AWS, and Azure.

SELECTED EXPERIENCE

CEO & Co-founder / Product Lead | woku

September 2023 - August 2026 | Chile

- Leads end-to-end strategy and execution for an AI-powered customer feedback platform, from discovery and workflow design through frontend implementation and launch.
- Translates customer needs into features for rapid feedback capture, NPS and forms, AI-assisted analysis, alerts, and WhatsApp and API integrations.
- Connects product, UX/UI, growth, sales, and implementation to keep the roadmap aligned with business outcomes and real customer workflows.
- Won more than 50 customers across Chile, Peru, and Colombia.
- Secured USD 70,000 in non-dilutive, equity-free funding from CORFO.

Co-founder & Brand Artisan, Product Design | Inpla

May 2025 - January 2026 | Chile

- Won the first customer, Puerto Coronel, before a product existed by selling the vision alone.
- Co-created the product, user experience, brand, and positioning.
- Helped shape a platform that allows companies to chat with their data.

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EXPERIENCE, EDUCATION AND EVIDENCE

CEO & Co-founder | stow SpA

October 2020 - December 2022 | Concepción, Chile

- Built a Chilean technology startup from concept to market.
- Contributed directly across product strategy, design, development, sales, and operations.
- Selected for the third cohort of Start-Up Chile's BUILD program in 2022.
- Received USD 10,000 in non-dilutive, equity-free funding from Start-Up Chile.

Maintenance Planning Engineer | Essbio

May 2019 - July 2021 | Concepción, Chile

- Led an innovation process with 30 technicians to improve the company's maintenance processes.
- Used Carlos Osorio's (defi)2 innovation methodology.
- Created data models and decision-support visualizations for maintenance planning.

Lecturer | Universidad de Concepción

2023

- Taught Business Management.
- Coached students in Project Formulation and Evaluation.

CEO | Orvita

2018 - 2019

- Led strategy and product development for a digital tourism venture.
- Developed the venture using funding obtained after the OPTIMA 2017 recognition.

EDUCATION

Master's in Innovation and Technology Entrepreneurship | Universidad de Concepción, 2023

Industrial Engineering | Universidad de Concepción, 2018

RECOGNITION

Best Undergraduate Paper | OPTIMA 2017

Developed an algorithm based on the traveling salesperson problem to recommend tourist routes according to a visitor's interests, available time, and budget. The work received the Best Undergraduate Paper award at the OPTIMA 2017 Congress. The recognition made it possible to obtain USD 7,000 in funding from the Chilean Institute for Operations Research, ICHIO, to develop Orvita.

PRESS

5 El Mercurio Innovation features: Woku, the Hualpén startup seeking to make rapid customer feedback easier; From podcasts to books: 10 entrepreneurs recommend content for the summer; New startup that lets companies chat with their data signs Puerto Coronel; What is it like to shut down a startup?; Made Inn Conce 2024: Four new startups from Biobío to watch.

Portfolio: <https://pauriquelmee.github.io/>

Woku: <https://woku.app> | Inpla: <https://inpla.ai/en/> | Methodology: <https://defi2.cc/>

LANGUAGES

English: full professional proficiency.